

DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES — FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION
MEDWATCH: THE FDA SAFETY INFORMATION AND ADVERSE EVENT REPORTING PROGRAM
FORM FDA 3500A (10/15) — MANDATORY ADVERSE EVENT & PRODUCT PROBLEM REPORTING
OMB Control No. 0910-0291 | For use by User-Facilities, Distributors, and Manufacturers

SECTION A: PATIENT INFORMATION

1. PATIENT IDENTIFIER A.P. (Arthur Pendelton)	2. AGE AT TIME OF EVENT 71 YRS	2a. DATE OF BIRTH 19-AUG-1954	3. SEX MALE	4. WEIGHT 74 kg (163 lbs)
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SECTION B: ADVERSE EVENT, PRODUCT PROBLEM OR ERROR

1. CHECK ALL THAT APPLY: ☒ ADVERSE EVENT ☐ PRODUCT PROBLEM (e.g., defects / contaminations)	REPORT TYPE: Mandatory 15-Day Alert
2. OUTCOMES ATTRIBUTED TO ADVERSE EVENT (Check all that apply): ☐ DEATH ☒ LIFE-THREATENING: YES (Septic Shock / MAP 45) ☒ HOSPITALIZATION — PROLONGED / CRITICAL CARE ICU ☐ DISABILITY OR PERMANENT DAMAGE ☐ CONGENITAL ANOMALY ☒ REQUIRED INTERVENTION TO PREVENT DAMAGE	3. DATE OF EVENT 14-NOV-2025 4. DATE OF THIS REPORT 14-NOV-2025
5. DESCRIBE EVENT OR PROBLEM (Include relevant tests, laboratory data, dates, and defect observations): At 11:30 on 14-NOV-2025, in Medical ICU (Northwestern Memorial Hospital), patient Arthur Pendelton (71M, post-op pneumonia) was initiated on an intravenous infusion of Cefatox 1g. After ~35mL infused, the bedside nurse noted visible turbidity and dark particulate matter inside the piggyback container. Infusion halted immediately. Within 45 minutes, patient developed acute rigors, temperature spike to 39.8°C (103.6°F), severe hypotension (BP 72/40 mmHg, MAP 50), and signs of distributive septic shock. Vasopressor therapy (Norepinephrine infusion titrated to 0.14 mcg/kg/min) and broad-spectrum empiric coverage initiated. PRODUCT DEFECT EXAMINATION: Visual inspection of vial Lot #CX54831 (Exp 08/25) confirmed a cracked aluminum crimp collar compromising container closure integrity, with visible black particulate matter floating in solution. Central pharmacy placed all 48 hospital vials of Lot #CX54831 into immediate quarantine. PHOTOGRAPHIC EVIDENCE: Detailed photographic evidence of compromised vial stopper and particulate matter is recorded in EXHIBIT 1 on Page 2 of this mandatory submission. Patient remains in critical condition under ICU resuscitation.	

SECTION C: SUSPECT PRODUCT(S) INFORMATION

1. NAME, STRENGTH, MANUFACTURER Cefatox (cefatoxime sodium) 1g for Inj.	2. DOSE, FREQUENCY & ROUTE 1g IV piggyback once	3. THERAPY DATES 14-NOV-2025 (Single partial dose)
4. DIAGNOSIS FOR USE Post-operative Aspiration Pneumonia	5. LOT / BATCH NUMBER Lot #CX54831	6. EXPIRATION DATE 08/2025
7. EVENT ABATED AFTER STOPPING? ☐ Yes ☒ No (ICU shock ongoing)	8. REAPPEARED AFTER REINTRODUCTION? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ N/A	9. PRODUCT DEFECT CONFIRMED? ☒ YES (Cracked seal & particulate)

SECTION E: INITIAL REPORTER INFORMATION

1. NAME AND ADDRESS OF REPORTER Robert Lang, MD, FCCM (Director of Critical Care Medicine) Northwestern Memorial Hospital — Medical ICU 251 E Huron St, Chicago, IL 60611, USA	2. HEALTH PROFESSIONAL? ☒ YES ☐ NO 3. OCCUPATION: Physician / Intensivist	4. CONTACT TELEPHONE & EMAIL: Tel: (312) 555-0320 Email: rlang@nmh-icu.org
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NORTHWESTERN MEMORIAL HOSPITAL — DEPARTMENT OF PHARMACY
RISK MANAGEMENT & QUALITY ASSURANCE ATTACHMENT
EXHIBIT 1: PHYSICAL EVIDENCE PHOTO LOG (QUARANTINED VIAL)

HOSPITAL INCIDENT REF: NMH-ICU-2025-449	EVIDENCE CUSTODIAN: Central Pharmacy QA	DATE PHOTOGRAPHED: 14-NOV-2025 12:15 CST
PRODUCT: Cefatox 1g for Injection (20ml)	LOT / BATCH: Lot #CX54831 (Exp 08/25)	SECURITY QUARANTINE SEAL: #NMH-Q-94821



PHYSICAL EVIDENCE INSPECTION FINDINGS:

- Closure Integrity Compromise:** Close examination of the 20mL glass container reveals an irregular mechanical rupture / tear in the aluminum crimp collar securing the blue elastomeric stopper. The seal was breached prior to reconstitution.
 - Foreign Particulate Contamination:** Macroscopic particulate matter (multiple dark, black/brown foreign fragments and flakes) is clearly visible suspended throughout the reconstituted solution under 2000-lux ambient cleanroom inspection lighting.
 - Regulatory Status:** Immediate manufacturer product quality alert issued; all 48 inventory units placed in locked quarantine.
- Investigator Note: Photograph entered into FDA Form 3500A Section B documentation as primary defect evidence.*